

Christmas Roses

by
Lizzie Lawson
and
Robert Alice Mack



Griffith, Farran & Company.

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Robert Ellice Mack



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Robert Ellice Mack

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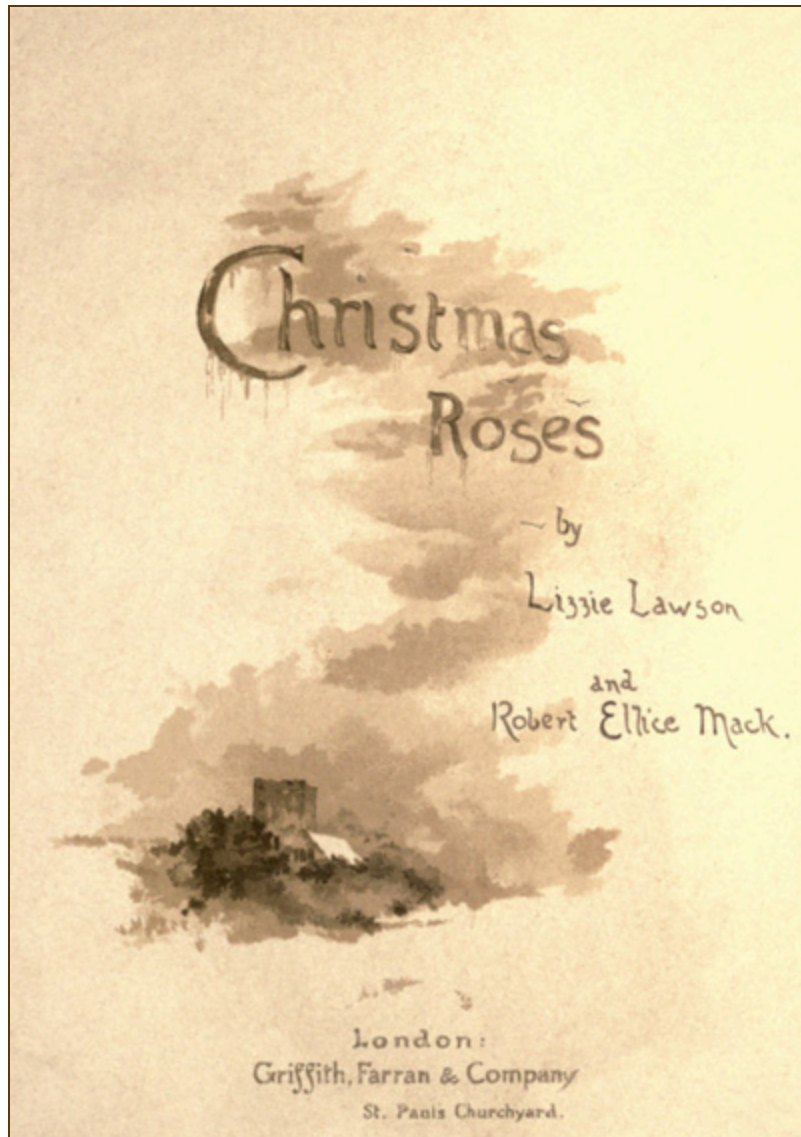
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*** START OF THE PROJECT GUTENBERG EBOOK CHRISTMAS
ROSES ***

Christmas Roses





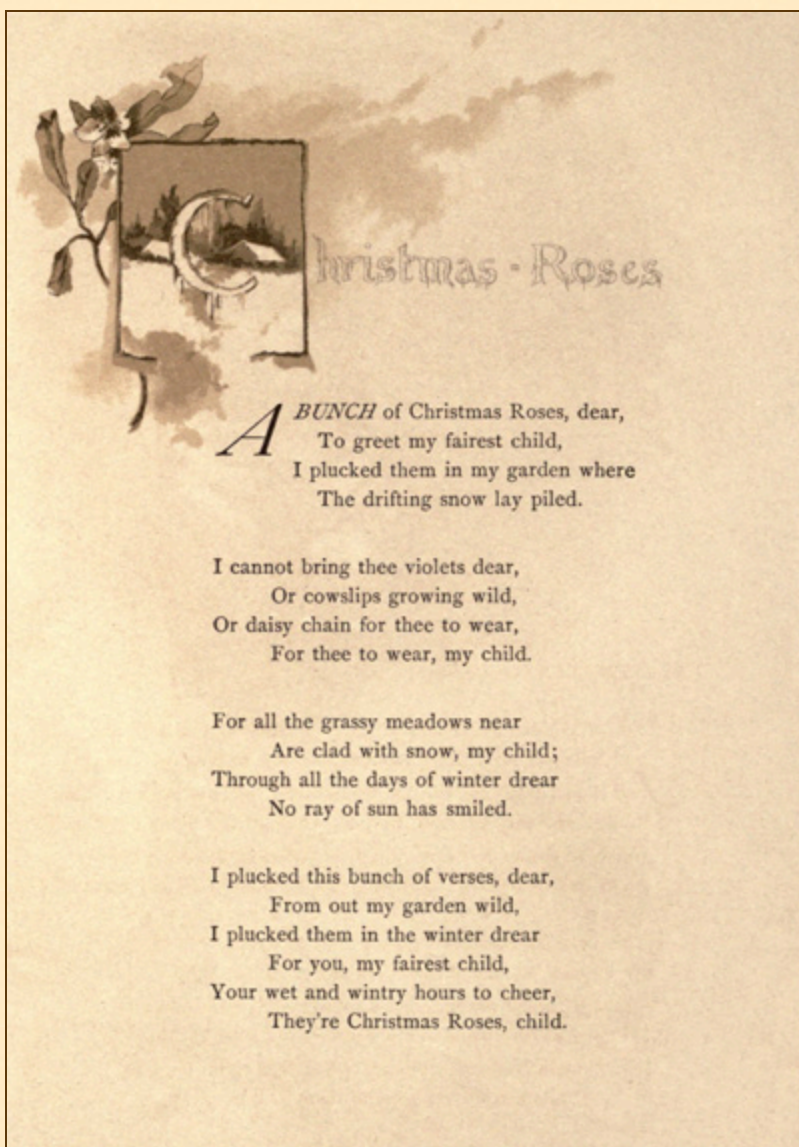
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**London:
Griffith, Farran & Company
St. Paul's Churchyard.**



CHRISTMAS ROSES



Christmas Roses

A *BUNCH* of Christmas Roses, dear,
To greet my fairest child,
I plucked them in my garden where
The drifting snow lay piled.

I cannot bring thee violets dear,
Or cowslips growing wild,
Or daisy chain for thee to wear,
For thee to wear, my child.

For all the grassy meadows near
Are clad with snow, my child;
Through all the days of winter drear
No ray of sun has smiled.

I plucked this bunch of verses, dear,
From out my garden wild,
I plucked them in the winter drear
For you, my fairest child,
Your wet and wintry hours to cheer,
They're Christmas Roses, child.



THE CHRISTMAS STOCKING.

"*I* *DONT* believe that Santa Claus will come to you and me,
Said little crippled Nell, " a'cause, we are so poor you see;
And then I don't believe the 'chimbley's' wide enough for him,
D'ye think that Santa Claus will come, when all the lights are dim."
"Of course he comes to every one, dear, whether rich or poor;
Now go to bed dear Nell," said Nan, "he'll come to-night I'm sure."

* * * * *

I don't know if by chimney or if by stair he crept,
But sure enough he visited the room where Nelly slept.
He brought a golden orange, and a monkey red and blue,
That climbed a little wooden stick in a way I couldn't do.
He hung them in Nell's stocking, and Nan was right, be sure,
That Santa Claus loves every one however rich or poor.

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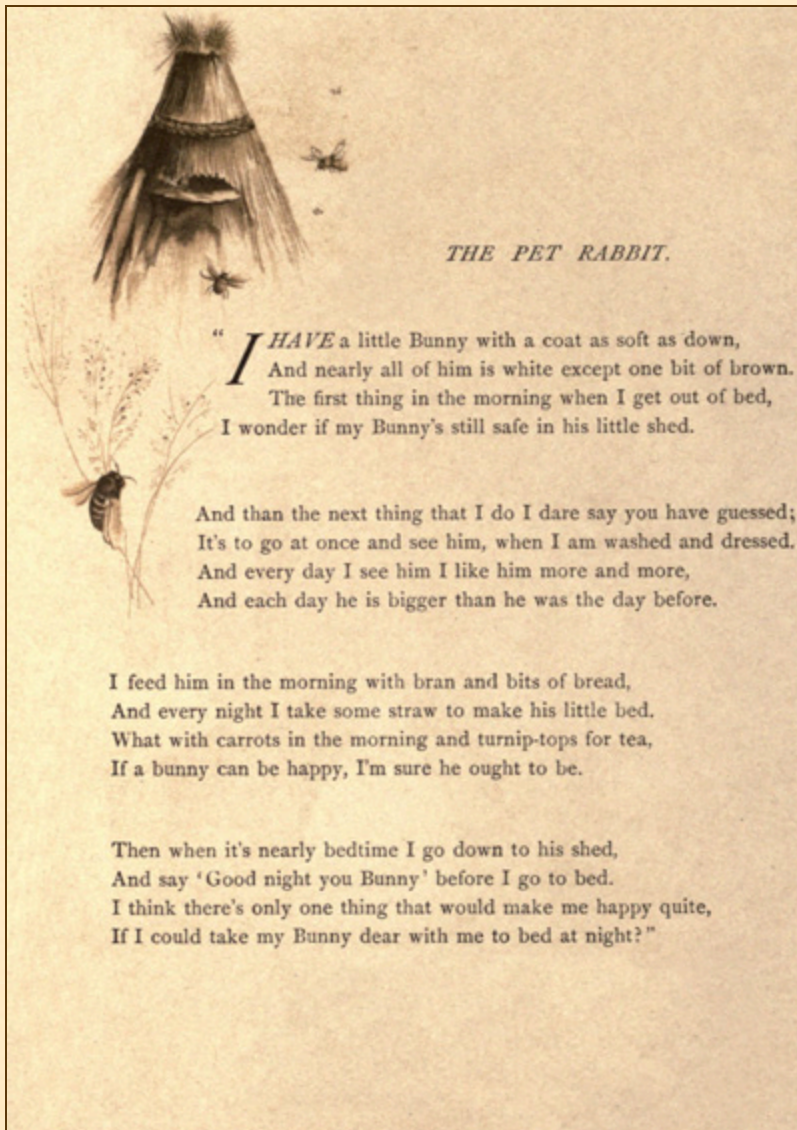
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That Santa Claus loves every one however rich or poor.



THE PET RABBIT.

I HAVE a little Bunny with a coat as soft as
down,

And nearly all of him is white except one bit
of brown.

The first thing in the morning when I get out of
bed,

I wonder if my Bunny's still safe in his little
shed.

And then the next thing that I do I dare say you
have guessed;

It's to go at once and see him, when I am washed
and dressed.

And every day I see him I like him more and
more,

And each day he is bigger than he was the day
before.

I feed him in the morning with bran and bits of
bread,

And every night I take some straw to make his
little bed.

What with carrots in the morning and turnip-tops
for tea,

If a bunny can be happy, I'm sure he ought to be.

Then when it's nearly bedtime I go down to his
shed,

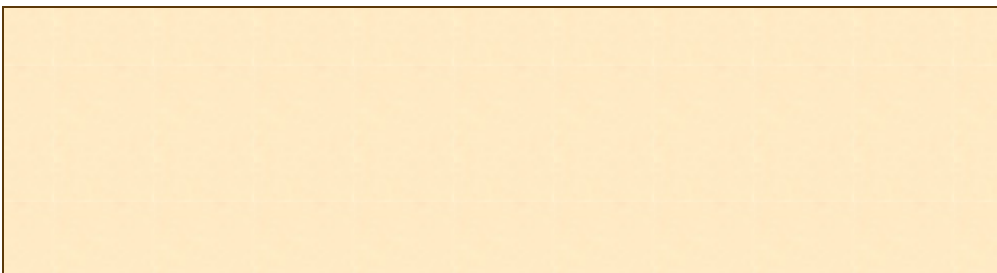
And say 'Good night you Bunny' before I go to
bed.

I think there's only one thing that would make me
happy quite,

If I could take my Bunny dear with me to bed at
night?"



THE PET RABBIT.





FATHERS BOAT.

*I*T'S Father's boat we're watching,
Away out on the sea,
She's named the Pretty Polly,
One hundred and ninety three,
Father called her the Polly,
After Mother and me.

There isn't a smarter boat
Than Father's on the sea,
The Pretty Polly is *our* ship,
Father's the skipper is he,
And we are watching for Father,
We're watching, Nancy and me.

Sometimes the wind blows wildly,
But Nancy, and Mother, and me,
We sing a bit of a hymn we know,
The hymn for those at sea,
Although when we think of Father,
We're as near to choke as can be.

To night the moon will be shining,
A sight it will be to see,
Father's ship all in silver,
A'sail on a silver sea,
And Father himself a coming home
To Mother and Nancy and me.



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FATHER'S BOAT.



A MISTAKE.

"*M*Y dears, whatever are you at?
You ought to be at home;
I told you not to wet your feet—
I told you not to roam.

"Oh, dear! I'm sure you will be drowned!
I never saw such tricks
Come home at once, and go to bed,
You naughty naughty chicks."

Now most of them were five days old,
But one, whose age was six—
"Please, ma'am," said he, "I think we're ducks;
I don't believe we're chicks!"

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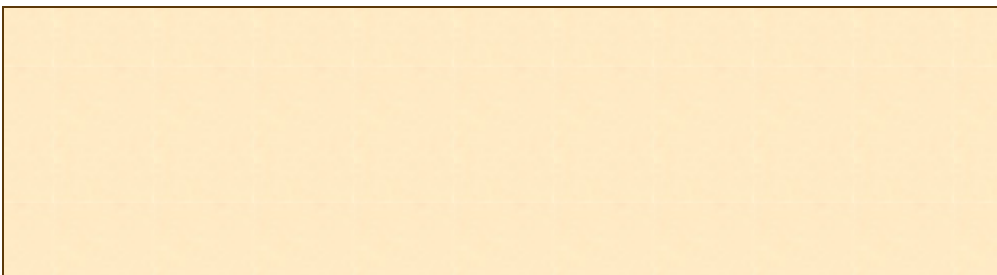
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“Please, ma’am,” said he, “I think we’re ducks;

I don’t believe we’re chicks!”



LITTLE DUCKS.





A SAD TALE.

"*WHO'S* afraid of a cat?" said he;
"I'm not afraid of a cat."

He was a bird who sat on a rail,
With five other birds, and this was his tale.

"I'm not afraid of a cat."

"I *might* be afraid if I were a mouse,
Or even if I were a rat:

But as I'm a bird
I give you my word
I'm not afraid of a cat."

A cat and her kits came down on the scene,
Five birds flew over the rail;
Our hero was caught
As quick as a thought,
And didn't he alter his tale!

"You've made a mistake, Mister Cat," said he;

"You must please let me go, Mister Cat.

I'm not at all nice,
I don't taste like mice:

You'd much better have a young rat."

Said the cat, "It's no use,

You may be a goose,
I'll not let you go for all that."



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THE CREW OF THE NANCY LEE.

*P*OLLY'S the mate of the Nancy Lee,
And Tom is the skipper bold,
They sail together
In rough wind and weather,
And they are the crew, all told.

In their taut and trim little boat they ride
Away o'er the bright blue sea,
With hands ever ready,
And hearts ever steady,
Whatever the dangers may be.
And a smarter crew will never be found,
Though you may search the whole world round.



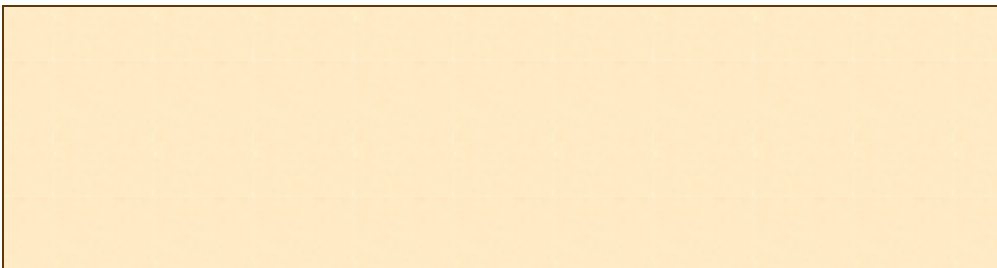
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HIE FOR CHRISTMAS.



HIE FOR CHRISTMAS!

B

RING Frost, bring Snow,
Come winter,
Bring us holly,
Bring Joy at Christmas,
Off with Melancholy!

Sing hie, sing hey,
Sing ho,
Sing holly,
Sing hie for Christmas!
Isn't winter jolly ?

Sing Jack, Sing Jill,
Sing Jo,
Sing Polly,
Sing hie for Christmas,
Mistletoe and Holly.



HIE FOR CHRISTMAS!

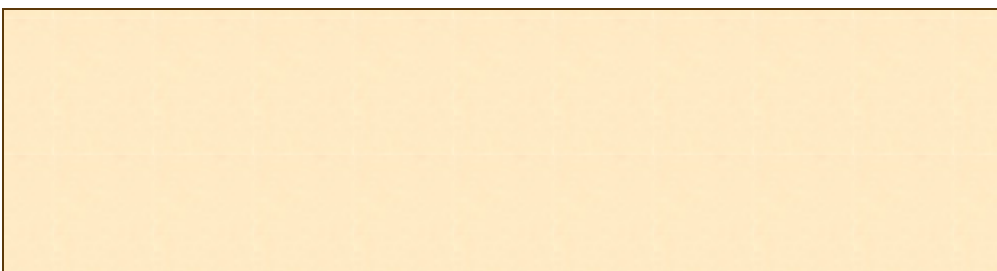
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Mistletoe and Holly.



PUTTING AWAY THE TOYS.





BEDTIME.

"*I*T'S bedtime, bedtime, Cissy dear,
It's time to put away,
Your little Noah's ark dear
Until another day,
You know it isn't right at all
To tire yourself with play.

And they too must be tired dear,
The elephants want to go
To bed,—if they're much later,
They'll all be ill I know,
And every well bred camel,
Is in bed long ago.

And surely you can see dear,
It really isn't right,
The little dove's so tired dear,
She scarce can stand upright.
It does not do to keep them up
So very late at night."



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PUSS IN THE CORNER.

" **Y***OU* are a naughty pussy-cat,
I think it right to mention that,
To all who see your picture here,
'Twas you who broke my Bunny dear.

An hour ago, as you can tell,
I left him here, alive and well;
And now he's *dead* and, what is more,
You've broke his leg I'm pretty sure.

For you my puss I'll never care,
No never, never, never, *there*,
And you are in disgrace you know,
And in the corner you must go.

What crying? Then I must cry too
And I can't bear to punish you;
Perhaps my Bunny isn't dead,
Perhaps you've only stunned his head.

And though I'm sure you broke his leg,
It may be mended with a peg,
And though he's very, very, funny,
My Bunny's not a real Bunny,
And I'll forgive and tell you that,
You're my own precious pussy cat "

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PUSS IN THE CORNER.



THE LITTLE HE AND SHE.

*O*NCE there lived, I'm not sure where,
May be Arcadee,
Sweet-Heart and his mistress fair,
Little He and She;

And they danced a measure light,
Danced in very glee.
Hand in hand, a pretty sight,
Little He and She.

When they ceased his bright eyes fell,
Darling must we stay?
Can't we dance so happily
You and I for aye?

Then she clasped his hand again,
Whispered sweet and low,
"Dearest, always hand in hand
You and I will go."

So they danced with merry feet,
E'en in Arcadee,
Happier pair you ne'er will meet,
Little He and She.

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Little He and She.



LITTLE BO-PEEP.

*L*ITTLE Bo peep
has lost her Sheep,
(It's a secret to you
I'm confiding.)

At the end of the shelf,
Where she put them herself
Her Baa-lambs are safely hiding.

If you put a thing carefully, safely away,
You're sure not to find it when wanted next day.

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HOPES AND FEARS.



HOPES AND FEARS.

*L*IKE clouds that flit across the sky,
So follow hopes and fears.
What in these clouds see you and me
Dear Sweetheart, smiles or tears?

This little airy fleecy wing,
That flits across the blue,
What message Sweetheart does it bring
Of hope or fear to you?

Pray God it brings you *sunny hours*
And haply some few *tears*
To bless like showers your summer flowers
In the long coming years.

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THE STORY BOOK FAIRY.

SHALL I sing you a song, not short and not long,
Of a story-book fairy who hides all among
The covers and leaves of your pictures and prints,
And colors them all with such beautiful tints?

First he kisses the girls with the fairest of curls
Then they blush like red roses and each head whirls.
In each little eye drops a bit of blue sky,
And colors each frock with a wonderful dye.

His breathing I ween is the wonderful sheen,
That clothes trees and meadows with loveliest green,
The buttercups bold, it need hardly be told,
Are gilded by him with the finest of gold.

It is he I suppose who paints the red rose,
And the rest of the flowers which every one knows
And the same red will do (or a similar hue),
For Robin and little Red Riding Hood too.

He's awake it is said when you are abed,
For the picture-book doggies and cats must be fed,
To the picture-book children some stories he'll tell,
And sometimes he'll read them their verses as well.

The moment you open your picture book he
Is away out of sight as quick as can be,
For fairy law says that a fairy must die
The instant he's seen by one human eye.



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SPRING.

*T*HE tiny crocus is so bold
It peeps its head above the mould,
Before the flowers awaken,
To say that spring is coming, dear,
With sunshine and that winter drear
Will soon be overtaken.



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Before the flowers awaken,
To say that spring is coming, dear,
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GOLDEN DAYS.

*T*HERE are days of summer sunshine,
Of warm and sunny weather,
When the hedge is full of hawthorn
And hills are glad with heather.

There are days of silent sadness,
Of frost, and snow, and rain,
When we fear that summer's gladness
Will never come again.

And now our songs are minor key,
And now in merry tune;
The windward side will change to lee,
And January to June.

Day and night the sun is shining,
Though he may hide his head;
Each cloud has a silver lining,
The flowers are asleep not dead.

Every day may have its playtime
Made bright by cheerful lays;
And life be one long Maytime,
A year of golden days.

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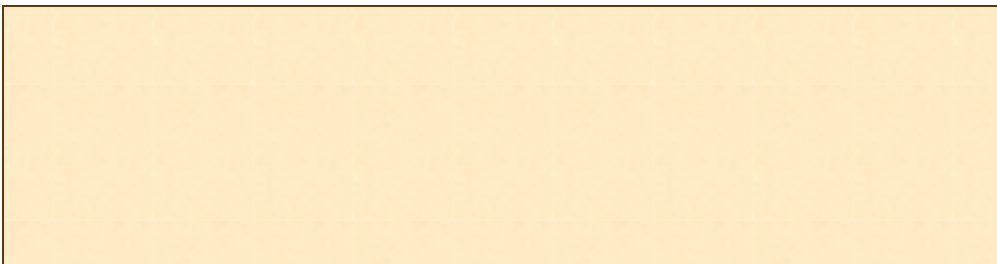
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GOLDEN DAYS.





A SLANDER.

"*SHAKE* hands, shake hands my little girl,"
Said Mister Crab to Nell,
"I'm very glad to meet you dear,
I hope you are quite well.
I think it's very hot to-day,
I feel it in my shell."

"I can't shake hands with you," said Nell,
"It isn't thought polite,
Without an introduction;
Besides, no doubt it's spite,
It mayn't be true, but still they do,
They do say that you—*BITE*."

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A SONG.

HEAR a Song
I think 'tis a thrush's.
He sings to the Wild Rose
See how she blushes!

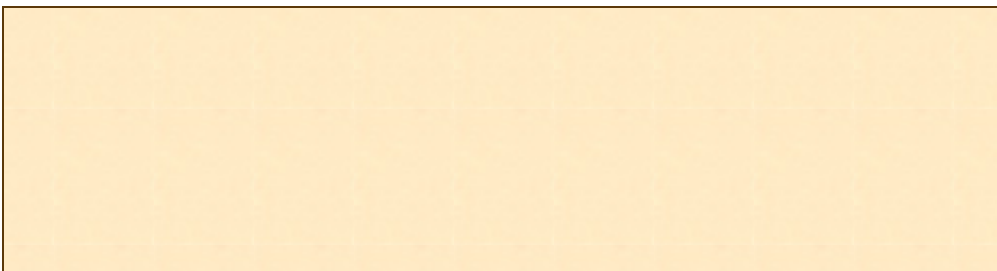


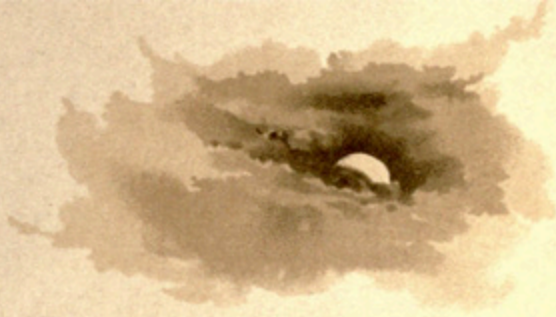
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THE EVENING HOUR.





NEARLY BEDTIME.

O *NLY* half an hour or so
Before nurse calls them to bed,
And the ruddy light of a cheerful fire
Shines over each curly head.

No trouble have they, no sorrow—
Their hearts are lighter than air,
No fear that a dark to-morrow
May bring with it want or care.

God send them each on their pathway
Many a wayside flower;
And grant, in the evening of lifetime,
The joy of the evening hour.

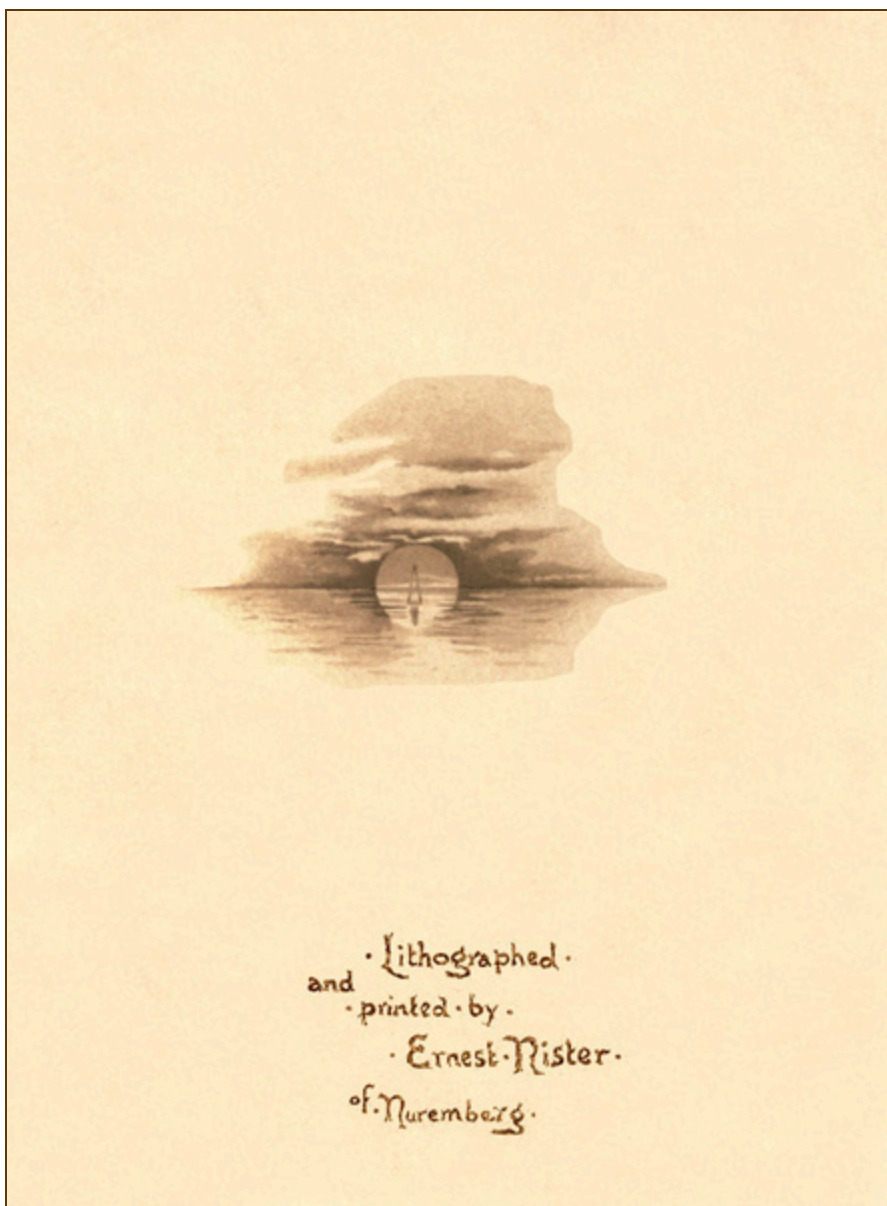


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Lithographed and printed by Ernest Nister of
Nuremberg.



Transcriber's Note:

In the first line of the second verse of The Pet Rabbit "[than](#)" has been changed to "then". An apostrophe has been added to the title of "[Father's Boat](#)" and a hyphen added to "[to-night](#)".

*** END OF THE PROJECT GUTENBERG EBOOK CHRISTMAS
ROSES ***

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